# How to Play

*Printable leaflet - two pages. Print this file directly (browser print or any Markdown-to-PDF tool), or read it on screen. Replaces the old `leaflet-how-to-play-A4-portrait.svg` / `leaflet-how-to-play-2-A4-portrait.svg` pair - same wording, plain text instead of hand-laid SVG.*

*Seven weeks. Thirty-five days. One project standing between your team and the deadline - your team commits five days at a time, resolves them all at once, then closes the week and moves on. From week 2, Events crash into the week you already committed to - spend Adaptability to re-plan around them or cancel them outright. Deliver every Feature before Week 7 closes to win the project - but hit a Team Score above the upper line (5 for every character you started with, plus 64) and you didn't just finish it, you built a team that could survive doing it again: Sustainable High Performance.*



## Setting up

*About fifteen minutes, and the first part is the best part.*

1. Deal each player five habitus parts at random and **assemble the figure** onto the Specimen

board.

1. Take the matching **NEED** tile (your VALUES) and **HERO** tile (your PRESSURE RESPONSE), and slot those

too.

1. Turn over board **THE ZONE**. Mark one square on the **SKILLS** grid on your own person board:

where your Head's row meets your Item's column.

1. Read what **Learn**/**Teach** do in one line each - no detail needed yet.
2. Pick one **PROJECT** card. Turn **THE PROJECT** face up and seat it - it names features A-F.
3. Read the project and its six features together - complexity, LOCK tiles across **D** and

**F**, what unlocks what.

1. Go through the **Activity cards** that come out now: **Work, Engagement, Celebrate, Workshop, Plan**. The

rest wait for later weeks.

### Finish the room

- Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** start face up. **SHIT HAPPENS** and **THE TEAM** stay

text side up; **THE DEVELOPMENT** stays boxed.

- **Motivation 4** for every character. Week marker on Week 1. Shuffle the Events but don't draw

yet.

- *Everything on the covered boards already sits at 1. It just isn't your problem for a few more

weeks.*

## Week 1

*Deliberately almost trivial - lay five cards, resolve them, close the week.*

*Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** are face up. Shit Happens, Adapt and the Ledger wait for week 2; the Specimen panel on your person board isn't read until week 3.*

1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday. They are the team's cards - nobody plays one. A slot may instead take a **Flex marker**, giving back a day someone worked as Overtime. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*

2 · The week runs

Resolve all **five** cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once, not one day at a time.

3 · Close the week

**Bank** any feature that finished (lift its lock, if any, and pay Capital). Everyone then **loses 1 Motivation** - the weekly grind. Nobody empties out on week 1 alone, so there is nothing else to check yet. *Move the week marker one step closer to the deadline. That's the whole week - three steps, no exceptions.*

*bank before the grind - it's the only spend this week.*

From week 2

**THE TEAM** turns face up: **the Ledger** - Trust, Capability, Shared Practice, Standing - starts being read at Close the Week, and your **Need** (the tile on your person board) starts being checked. Adaptability is a shared pile of adapt tokens on Shit Happens. Nothing else about a week changes yet.

*A week is five days, and you choose them. That's the entire idea, before anything else gets added to it.*

**Flip this sheet when Week 1 closes → Week 2 on is on the back**

---

*The same five days, but the table has more to say about them with every week that passes.*

## The pulse, from week 2 on

*The same five steps, every week until week 7 closes.*

1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday - the team's cards, nobody plays one. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*

2 · Shit happens

Draw **two Event cards, face up** - and **do not resolve them yet**. They are threats, aimed at the week you already committed. *A day spent on the wrong thing is simply lost.*

3 · Adapt

Spend **adapt tokens** from the shared pool: pay an Event's ADAPT number to cancel it outright.

4 · The week runs

Resolve whatever survived Adapt, then all five cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once.

5 · Close the week

**Bank** completed features (lift any lock) → **walk the Ledger** coins, at most one step each, and flip any that reached its ring → **Motivation as one net number**: −1 for the grind - every week, ±1 per matching Event category per Torso (check who was hit and who was immune), +1 if the Need was met.

*bank first - it lifts locks and tells you whether Celebrate had something to mark.*
*apply motivation as one number, then check for zero.*

**Week 2:** the Ledger (with Standing and Capital), the Adaptability pool, your Need, and Shit Happens/Adapt, together. The Demo card opens, with Learn, Teach and Reflect. **Week 3:** the Development + the Flex and Overtime part of the Specimen panel. No new cards. **Week 4:** nothing new. **Week 5:** Combos - two named triggers in the same week now pay a small bonus on top of what they already did alone (rulebook §18.1).

## How it ends

*The project ends when Week 7 closes.*

**Team Score** = (features × 12) + (3 tracks + adapt tokens, max 21) + (Motivation) + (12 × Habits held) − (40 × quits) − (2 × unrepaid Flex) − (5 × tracks that finish at 0 or 1)

**If any feature is missing, the Team Score is 0. It never goes below 0.**

Two lines: **5 for every character you started with, minus 24** (lower) and **5 for every character, plus 64** (upper).

| Outcome | Condition | |
|---|---|---|
| **Failure** | Not everything delivered. | *The score is 0.* |
| **Heroic Success** | All six banked, score under the lower line. | *The project made it. The team didn't.* |
| **Sustainable Performance** | All six banked, score between the two lines. | *The team held together.* |
| **High Performance** | All six banked, score on or over the upper line. | *You built a team as well.* |

*If you only had thirty-five working days, how would you spend them?*